

KYLE GAARDER

Member Experience Designer | Community Programming | Ops

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SUMMARY

Member experience designer who builds community programming from scratch. Designed and ran the complete resident experience at a coliving property - 48 weekly events, 4 mastermind programs, and 6 work-trade initiatives. I specialize in creating intentional, relationship-driven, operationally excellent member experiences in shared spaces.

For Industrious: I design intentional member experiences in shared spaces — 48 weekly events, onboarding systems, and retention that sustained 94% occupancy.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed complete member experience - onboarding, engagement, retention, and conflict resolution
- Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
- Built community-driven retention sustaining 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
- Executed A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining member satisfaction
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY across all member touchpoints
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining community trust and continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots community outreach
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand member needs and experience preferences
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led member experience design across strategy, ops, and community in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Complete MX from Scratch

Designed end-to-end member experience - onboarding, engagement, events, and resolution



48+ Community Programs

Built 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs driving member engagement



94% Retention via Experience

Experience-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months



Investor Pilot Secured

Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states



Demand Pipeline Built

Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Member Experience Design

Community Programming

Operational Excellence

Event Design & Facilitation

Retention Strategies Onboarding

Conflict Resolution Comms

Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0